



Tuck School of Business at Dartmouth
Tuck Business Bridge Program
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June 26, 2026

RE: Aynura Erejepbaeva

To Whom It May Concern:

Please accept this letter as confirmation of Aynura Erejepbaeva's completion of the Tuck Business Bridge Program, held at the Tuck School of Business at Dartmouth, from June 7 - 26, 2026 .

The Tuck Business Bridge Program is a highly selective program for liberal arts and STEM undergraduates and recent grads. Although this is a non-degree program, the Tuck Bridge Program has a competitive admissions process. The purpose of the program is to give students a rigorous introduction to global business, and to teach them practical and analytical decision-making skills.

The program introduces substantive topics in financial accounting, corporate finance, managerial economics, communications, marketing, spreadsheet modeling, and strategy. Additional topics include ethics, Excel skills, organizational behavior, and team building. All coursework is taught by the senior MBA faculty at the Tuck School of Business at Dartmouth. A breakdown of course objectives and hours are included in this document.

During the program, two to four classes are held each day, and each requires significant outside preparation by the student. Students also participate in small group projects and presentations, including a capstone company valuation for their final presentation.

Please feel free to call our team at (603) 646-6459 if you require further information on the Tuck Business Bridge Program or visit our website at <https://bridge.tuck.dartmouth.edu>.

Bridge Academic Class Hours: 67
Instructional Career Development Hours: 5.25
Instructional Capstone Project Hours: 5.3
Final Grade: Pass

Sincerely,

Lisa Tedeschi
Assistant Dean, Tuck Undergraduate Education



**TUCK
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TUCK BUSINESS BRIDGE COURSE OBJECTIVES

First Principles Thinking for AI-Augmented Professionals

This class introduces students to first principles thinking as a foundational approach for integrating generative AI into professional work. Students will learn to move beyond surface-level AI applications and trending prompts to develop strategic, thoughtful approaches to AI integration in their careers. Through interactive exercises, participants will deconstruct professional roles and workplace challenges to their fundamental components, then rebuild solutions that effectively leverage AI capabilities while preserving essential human value. Using real-world scenarios from entry-level positions across various business functions, students will practice identifying where AI genuinely enhances work versus where human judgment remains irreplaceable. The session culminates in students developing personal frameworks for evaluating and implementing AI tools in a professional context.

Business Communications

The Business Communication course will help you create and deliver the professional presentation of your corporate valuation. Many of you are already strong communicators; this course will translate what you already know to a business audience.

Business Ethics

Ethical dilemmas surface in almost every career. We can't predict when, but we can prepare. Recent ethical scandals at Theranos and FTX have highlighted potential moral traps for entrepreneurs, investors, and employees. We will tackle a specific ethical dilemma that a young employee in a Venture Capital firm faces early in his career and try to determine a reasonable action plan. We will also discuss developing a set of personal principles that may help you navigate challenging situations.

Corporate Finance

Finance is the study of the allocation of scarce resources over time and under uncertainty, particularly relating to decision-making in corporations and financial markets. It covers a range of topics including capital raising, investment analysis, valuation, risk management, financial planning, and the design of financial instruments and institutions. Finance draws on key principles from economics, such as market efficiency, incentives, and equilibrium, and from accounting, which provides the information required to measure performance, assess value, and make informed financial decisions.

Financial Accounting

This course provides an overview of financial accounting concepts and theory. Journal entries, along with the underlying accounting equation, will be covered. A primary focus will be on understanding and preparing the three core financial statements in anticipation of moving forward with the development of a 3-statement model utilizing Excel. The 3-statement model will also require financial statement analysis and forecasting skills.

Investments

A discounted cash flow framework typically involves the “long” view: long project horizons, long-term costs of capital, long-term expectations of cash flows. As such, the resulting net present values are somewhat “sticky.” Yet market valuations for public companies are comparatively volatile. How does one reconcile this gap in valuation volatility? How do we go from the intrinsic value of a company to the market value of a company? In this session, we’ll explore what happens after the discounted cash flow exercise is completed and how factors outside the DCF framework – namely, Fed influences on the yield curve – affect expectations and perceptions of value.

Leading Self, Teams & Others

In today’s workplaces, technical expertise is not enough to lead through transformation, ambiguity, and complexity. Future-ready leaders cultivate essential human skills –self-awareness, compassion, communication, and collaboration – that enable them to guide high-performing teams. This series helps students recognize that effective leadership begins with the inner work of understanding values, preferences, and perceptions. By connecting this self-knowledge to the dynamic stages of team development, students will explore and practice leading through conflict, cultivating psychological safety, and leveraging team strengths to achieve shared goals and take wise action as a team. Students will also learn to navigate tough conversations, recognize and apply creative intelligences, and design intentional career pathways that align with their personal leadership brand. Students will strengthen critical leadership skills in self-awareness, reflection, and candid dialogue – the foundation for leading cohesive teams for collective success.

Managerial Economics

Economics can help us understand issues ranging from income inequality to traffic congestion. It is also a useful tool for making personal and business decisions. The Tuck Bridge economics course has four principal objectives:

1. Deepen students’ understanding of how markets operate and when they fail to achieve a socially efficient outcome (market failure).
2. Introduce the most important microeconomic concepts and teach students to recognize them in real world situations.
3. Explore how the core economic tools can be used successfully in business and government.
4. Prepare students for the Capstone Project.

The material will be taught through real world examples. The readings and homework have been chosen to promote a deeper understanding of important concepts. Class discussions will be based on the Socratic method. Students should come prepared to discuss the readings and the homework questions.

Marketing

This course is designed to provide you with an introduction to the fundamental building blocks of marketing. In this course, we will explore key marketing concepts including: The Marketing Mix (Product Price, Place and Promotion), brand equity and the marketing environment. Students will gain understanding of marketing strategy. Included in our exploration into marketing strategy we will cover: segmentation, targeting, and positioning. At the end of this course students will have a tool kit that they can apply to the analysis and application of marketing strategy for their businesses.

Spreadsheet Modeling/Data Visualization

The goal of this module is to expose the participants to spreadsheet modeling. We focus on how to build and use a spreadsheet model as a laboratory for learning about a business problem or decision. This requires learning the basics of spreadsheet engineering: how to design, build, and test a spreadsheet model and how to use it for business analysis.

Strategy

Business strategy fundamentally comes down to two interrelated questions: where to play and how to play. Across two sessions, you will build a foundational toolkit for strategic analysis. The first session focuses on external analysis—understanding where to play by evaluating the broader environment and the competitive dynamics of an industry to assess its attractiveness. The second session turns inward to internal analysis and positioning—understanding how to play by examining a company's resources and capabilities and how they translate into a sustainable competitive advantage. Together, these tools will give you a structured way to evaluate any company's strategic position and the foundations of its long-term performance.

Elective: Advanced Investments

Advanced Investments will introduce students to the professional frameworks used by institutional portfolio managers and CIOs. Starting with an interactive stock market simulation followed by discussion, students will get a sense of the relative importance of picking winning securities versus paying attention to risk management, diversification, and the utility of having a written investment policy before making any decisions. We will review professional metrics (volatility, drawdown, beta, Sharpe ratio), and their role in systematic (rather than emotional) investing. And we will discuss some of the underpinnings of a foundational document in investing - the investment policy statement.

Elective: Entrepreneurship

This class introduces the four key frameworks for applying entrepreneurial thinking: Hypothesis-Driven Entrepreneurship, Lean Canvas/Lean Methodology, Customer Discovery, and Human-Centered Design/Design Thinking as it applies to startups. These frameworks can apply to various aspects of your professional life.

Elective: Intro to Private Equity

This elective is an introduction to private equity – often referred to as 'buy side' investing. Students will get an understanding of various types of private equity firms and investment focuses, targeting more mature companies across all industry sectors. As an interactive component, students will brainstorm together to come up with at least 10 to 12 companies' representative of each type of private equity investment discipline. The course will delve deeper into each investment discipline to provide a basic understanding of private equity. The class will include recent private equity transactions as study examples for class discussion. Students are welcome to bring their own examples of private equity transactions they've read about or experienced through work or study.

The class will conclude with what career opportunities in private equity for college graduates and how to pursue this career path.

Elective: Intro to Venture Capital

This elective is an introduction to the business of venture capital investing. Students will get an understanding of how venture capital firms work, how they put capital, or money, to work investing in startups and very young companies. As part of this interactive learning experience, students will first share their own or brainstorm startup ideas to create what's known as a deal pipeline. Using this pipeline as examples, the course instruction will give definition to how the venture capital business works, what practitioners do day to day, why they invest in risky startups, and what are the alternatives are for startups seeking funding. With a basic understanding of VC, the second class activity will focus on choosing what startups in the class-created pipeline students now acting as investors would invest in and how much.

The class will conclude with what career opportunities exist in venture capital for college graduates and how to pursue this career path.

Elective: Out of Silicon Valley - The New Leadership Model

The old model of leadership is increasingly obsolete leading to a mandate for a more open and collaborative approach. We will look at the general principles, practices and themes of a new leadership model, and provide a step-by-step process for its implementation. This method will be illustrated by concrete examples from real

world, in-the-trenches transformational experiences.

Elective: Problem Solving in Consulting

Problem-solving sits at the core of many business jobs, particularly consulting. This session will cover the scientific method of problem-solving, which many of the world's top consultancies use to help clients solve their toughest business challenges. We will work through how to properly frame a problem, develop a well-structured/hypothesis-driven approach, leverage core analytical tools, and ultimately deliver a recommendation. This session will be interactive, so come ready to learn and apply this new skill.

Elective: Pharmacy/BioTech

This elective offers an introduction to the pharmaceutical and biotechnology industries, rapidly growing sectors that are valued at over \$3 trillion globally. Using a case-study approach, students will explore the key drivers of a successful drug launch, including choices regarding R&D investments, regulatory strategy, manufacturing, pricing, marketing, and sales. The session highlights how these functions work together to launch major therapies and will conclude with an overview of career paths available to undergraduates interested in biotech and pharma.

Elective: Real Estate

This class provides an overview of the \$20 trillion commercial real estate industry, introduces techniques for evaluating real estate investments, and applies those techniques in a short case study of an apartment rental via Airbnb.

Team Capstone Project

The Tuck Bridge Capstone Project allows students to apply the skills they acquire in the classroom to analyze and value a real-world business. Each team will select a publicly-traded company, analyze its business, and determine how much the company is worth. At the end of the Business Bridge program, teams will present their recommendations and conclusions to professionals from major investment banks, international consulting firms, peers, and members of the Tuck faculty.

Students will choose a public company and derive an "intrinsic value" for the company. A commonly accepted definition of intrinsic value is "The price a rational investor is willing to pay for an investment, given its level of risk." Intrinsic value measures the value of an investment based on its cash flows. Where market value tells you the price other people are willing to pay for a company, intrinsic value generates a company value based on an objective analysis of a company's current and expected future performance and risk. Bridge students will learn and apply the discounted cash flow (DCF) method for calculating the intrinsic value of the public company they chose. To determine value using DCF students need to estimate future cash flows and select an appropriate discount rate. Through the DCF, they will learn both fundamental drivers of company value as well as the nuanced competitive and economic factors that influence those fundamental drivers.

This project is not meant to be a stock-picking exercise (even though many "stock pickers" and Wall Street analysts would conduct a similar investigation). Rather it is the kind of analysis that would be conducted by a buyer interested in acquiring the entire business. Based on their extensive company analysis, each team will make a recommendation to such a potential acquirer. The recommendation will include the purchase price that the investor would be willing to pay for all the company's equity. Students should also strive to offer suggestions as to how the new owner might improve the company's performance going forward.



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TUCK BUSINESS BRIDGE COURSE OVERVIEW

COURSE	# OF CLASSES	TOTAL MINUTES	TOTAL HOURS
BUSINESS COMMUNICATIONS	4	360	6
CORPORATE FINANCE	7	600	10
ELECTIVES (Adv. Investments, Consulting, Entrepreneurship, Leadership, Pharma/BioTech, Private Equity, Real Estate, VC)	4	360	6
ETHICS	1	90	1.5
FINANCIAL ACCOUNTING	6	540	9
FIRST PRINCIPLES THINKING FOR AI-AUGMENTED PROFESSIONALS	1	90	1.5
LEADING SELF, TEAMS & OTHERS	5	450	7.5
EXCEL FOUNDATIONS	1	90	1.5
INVESTMENTS	1	90	1.5
MANAGERIAL ECONOMICS	4	360	6
MARKETING	4	360	6
SPREADSHEET MODELING/DATA VISUALIZATION	5	450	7.5
STRATEGY	2	180	3
CAPSTONE PROJECT	6	320	5.3
CAREER DEVELOPMENT	7	315	5.25
	58	4655	77.55
Total Instructional Class Time	45	4,020	67
Total Instructional Career Development (Elective)	7	315	5.25
Total Instructional Capstone Project Time	6	320	5.3
Minutes Per Class Session		90	
Minutes Per Lab/Career Session		45-60	